WEEK 15 / FUTURE DIRECTIONS AND SYNTHESIS

Final Reflection: Gaming's Past, Present, and Future

So What? What Now?

This week, we wrap up the course by reflecting on the key themes and insights we've explored. We will discuss the future of gaming and its potential impact on society, culture, and technology.

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7 RESOURCES / 1 TOPIC

TOPIC 01

Synthesis and Future Directions

REQUIRED

Game Changers: The Evolution and Impact of Video Games

YOUTUBE | 50 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2JIf1AuyYvw

LO 1: Students will be able to explain the historical development of video games, from early arcade games to contemporary digital gaming platforms.
LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.
LO 5: Students will gain insights into how technologies like artificial intelligence, virtual reality, and online connectivity shape gaming experiences.
LO 8: Students will be able to discuss potential future trends in gaming, reflecting on emerging technologies, cultural shifts, and player expectations.

REQUIRED

What Does the Future of Gaming Look Like?

ARTICLE | 14 MIN

https://builtin.com/articles/future-of-gaming

LO 5: Students will gain insights into how technologies like artificial intelligence, virtual reality, and online connectivity shape gaming experiences.
LO 8: Students will be able to discuss potential future trends in gaming, reflecting on emerging technologies, cultural shifts, and player expectations.

REQUIRED

Organized labor could level up the video game industry

AUDIO/SUMMARY | 51 MIN

https://wdet.org/2024/10/28/organized-labor-could-level-up-the-video-game-industry/

LO 1: Students will be able to explain the historical development of video games, from early arcade games to contemporary digital gaming platforms.
LO 2: Students will be able to critically assess how video games reflect and shape cultural values, norms, and societal issues.
LO 4: Students will be able to discuss ethical concerns surrounding gaming, including issues related to violence, addiction, monetization practices, labor concerns, and virtual identities.
LO 8: Students will be able to discuss potential future trends in gaming, reflecting on emerging technologies, cultural shifts, and player expectations.

EXPLORE FURTHER

How gaming can be a force for good

TED TALK

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=XdqV66m7Los

EXPLORE FURTHER

Will videogames become better than life?

TED TALK

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mfv_hOFT1S4

EXPLORE FURTHER

2025 GDC State of the Game Industry Panel

PANEL RECORDING | 64 MIN

https://gdcvault.com/play/1034964/2025-GDC-State-of-the?_mc=em_gdcsf_x_le_x_07monthly_x_2025&sp_aid=130571&elq_cid=48662221&sp_eh=2efa3328470884738b2637e8dfca828ba32f7293f0eeeaa2da563c02bcf10afa&sp_eh=2efa3328470884738b2637e8dfca828ba32f7293f0eeeaa2da563c02bcf10afa&utm_source=eloqua&utm_medium=email&utm_campaign=13_NL_GDCNL25_Batch7_A_EDNLSUB_SUBS_7132329447_July_20250731&sp_cid=58845&utm_content=13_NL_GDCNL25_Batch7_A_EDNLSUB_SUBS_7132329447_July_20250731

2025 GDC State of the Game Industry Panel

EXPLORE FURTHER

The History of Every Video Game Genre

YOUTUBE | ~70 MIN

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dbgdi7BzMR0

This is a recent video that I will use at the beginning of the course going forward but thought was worth sharing now - enjoy!

LO 1: Students will be able to explain the historical development of video games, from early arcade games to contemporary digital gaming platforms.